Attendees

- June (Den, Macrocosm)
- AdmiralObvious (Wizden Headmin)
- Aexxie (Wizden Acting Director)
- Aku (Carpmosia)
- aquif (Cosmatic Drift)
- AugustSun (Wizden Public Relations)
- Bird (Starlight)
- Chief_Engineer (Unaffiliated)
- Crazybrain (Wizden)
- Denthamos (Paradise)
- Errant (Wizden Maintainer)
- Falcon (Aurora's Song)
- Fan (Impstation, Aurora's Song)
- Fried (Moffstation)
- FSP (Unaffiliated)
- G (Funky)
- Geekyhobo (Unaffiliated)
- Gray (Harmony)
- hivehum (Impstation, Macrocosm)
- huck (Den, Macrocosm)
- Jimboe (Delta-V)
- Kamila (Starlight)
- lobsterpaw (Impstation, Macrocosm)
- lunarcomets (Cosmatic Drift)
- mkanke (Funky, Macrocosm)
- mqole (Impstation, Macrocosm)
- Nairod (Cosmatic Drift)
- Nem (Temporarily)
- Nyx (Wizden Infra)
- OrksAreDaBest (Wizden Maintainer)
- Pox (Aurora's Song)
- PrincessCheeseballs (Unaffiliated)
- r3d (Starlight)
- Red Mushie (Starlight)
- Ret (Wizden Acting Director)
- Skarlet (Unaffiliated)
- Slarti (Unaffiliated
- Slam (Unaffiliated)
- SnappingOpossum (Carpmosia)
- Supar (Carpmosia)

- Sympara (Carpmosia)
- taydeo (Funky, Macrocosm)
- Tess (Starlight)
- Toboe (Moffstation)
- Trosling (Starlight)
- UpAndLeaves (Wizden Moderator)
- wavesneglected (Carpmosia)
- Whisper (RMC)

Slides: SCC Meeting Agenda 10th of October

Date: Oct 10, 2026

Minutes taken by mqole (493234058088677379)

Meeting chaired by june (244251706794180609)

Topics

Welcome WizDen reps & associates to meeting

Current WizDen members in the SCC server are:
- AdmiralObvious
- Aexxie
- AugustSun
- DrSmugleaf
- Errant
- Julian
- Ress
- UpAndLeaves
- Simyon
- OrksAreDaBest
- Samuka
- Nyx
- Ret
- Crazybrain

Thank you to those who could attend for being at this meeting!

Check in

Follow up on status of ongoing vote

hivehum: "Do we think it is a good idea to form a separate organization to handle engine, authentication, and hub maintenance of SS14? If this vote succeeds we would start the process of organizing. This would be a separate organization independent from any fork." is currently 18 "yes", 6 "no" and 8 "abstains"

chief: We have like a week left on it rn so I think we should wait for updates before focusing on that

WizDen's meeting earlier (context)

taydeo: watched as much as could on 2x speed, skipping around. couldn't get everything. 2 meetings: first is an hour, second is eight minutes (botched upload, Ret to re-upload). Video shared in SCC 40 minutes prior to meeting. Nyx shares transcripts in meeting chat. Slam brought up proposal. Trosling has both hour-long recordings. Darkrell also attended the first meeting (director meeting) proposing to help out with temp engine maintenance.

aexxie: IJK member of PR under princess, took up position of acting comms director in absence. Aexxie has taken over, IJK has stepped down for personal reasons. Aexxie is comms director for the time being.

taydeo: meeting on 8th of oct, changes since then. A lot of the meeting on the 8th was discussing slam's proposal. Ret is the one who shared meetings- with ret's blessing we will proceed.

ret: in support of this agenda for meeting.

Proposals

Slam's proposal

slam: geeky will be speaking, slam will be supporting in text chat

geeky: sent a copy of slam's proposal in chat. Messaged veritable last night, spent an hour on the phone speaking about proposal, gave an ultimatum "what is needed for you to step down and accept slams proposal". sent proposal agreed on pending review in about a week.

slam: Important context, as this has been discussed with Veritable: The proposal is notional and subject to further revision. It is not to be considered the final commitment of Wizden yet.

SLAM'S PROPOSAL BEGINS:

Written by SlamBamActionman

Original on 7/10/2026

Updated 10/10/2026.

Hello directors Et. al.

I will start by stating some facts that are motivations for why I will be proposing what comes later, and serve as context for this discussion taking place. These are facts as I see them; if you disagree because you have another perspective, that is fine, but I am not interested in litigating them.

The facts as I see them

Wizden as a game development project is currently in an unsustainable position for its long-term health. 19 active core staff members have either left or intend to leave, with an additional 10 currently observing the situation with the intent to leave around the end of the week if they are not satisfied with the board of directors' (BoD's) outcome. The main body of remaining staff are either game administrators and infrastructure developers, motivated by a sense of duty to the playerbase and community, with critically low trust in the BoD. Additionally, as of yesterday several of the large downstreams of the Space Continuance Commission have begun preparations to transfer away from Wizden as a content upstream, as an engine upstream, and as an auth upstream. The SCC is taking its time to gather opinions and allow its members to cool off, but it is progressing. A key distinction to the incident in May is that there is a much stronger sentiment to hardfork away from Wizden permanently. The BoD is currently in an untenable position when it comes to staff trust, public sentiment, and downstream relations.

What is being proposed:

There are four parts to the proposed changes:

- Rebuilding trust in staff leadership.
- Rebuilding trust in the infra.
- Rebuilding trust in the upstream.
- Rebuilding trust in the organization.

Rebuilding trust in staff leadership

As the current BoD will not be able to rebuild their trust with the staff team, community and downstreams. This transfer would be to a group of individuals in high standing with staff and community with a track record of integrity. The following individuals are the ones I propose for this group:

- Myself
- Simyon (Previously Julian, unavailable)
- AdmiralObvious
- Scholar_nz
- CrudeOil
- AugustSun
- Diego

These individuals are not people I believe exhibit the necessary expertise in all the areas for the three parts below, talented as they are. They are chosen based on their ability to bring back the people who do have that expertise, their ability to listen and lead, and my judgement of their willingness to agree to this. While

from different disciplines, these individuals are not meant to act in replacement positions to the current structure of the BoD. Their purpose is to ensure that the other three parts below can be accomplished on a project scale.

Rebuilding trust in the infra

As has been shown by this and past events, Space Station 14 infrastructure is susceptible to unrelated issues stemming from content and engine development. As players and downstream developers rely on our core infra services to function, losing trust in this means a real risk to the longevity of the SS14 platform as a whole. Additionally, SS14 infrastructure can and is run separately from Wizden servers. The SS14 infra would be split off from Wizden into a separate team and entity, though still under the Robust Interactive LLC umbrella. We are talking separate Discord, separate team, separate Patreon for funds. There will naturally be an overlap between SS14 engine/content developers and SS14 infrastructure personnel, but the infra team should be able to focus on their mission without concern of Wizden development.

Rebuilding trust in the upstream

There have been permanent losses of talent and personnel to this project. It will not be feasible for the development team to continue development in the same vein as previously. Additionally, downstreams will need reassurances that their expectations for Wizden being a reliable platform as an upstream are to be met. This ultimately needs to be done in discussion with the downstreams, but the following points are clear: There will be a drastic reduction in the scope of content development for an extended duration. Instead, focus will shift to documentation of the existing core systems and cleaning up any outstanding features still in the code base (or removal where not possible). After this stable version is completed, development will solely focus on targeted changes to core systems under a proper project production and project management system. This will come with some drawbacks. We will be unable to cater to contributors wishing to add features not deemed part of the targeted changes. Players of Wizden will be seeing less content updates as development slows. I have been assured that the admin team will put the health of the game first, but it will nonetheless impact that branch. In return we will become a higher quality platform that other Space Station 14 projects are able to rely on. Additionally, if the admin team wishes, this could be taken further by splitting up Wizden into core game development and Wizden-server development, treating Wizden like any other downstream in how it handles content and its repositories. It is too early to make this call, but this would help insulate Wizden's parts against internal conflict, and provide a Wizden-related avenue for contributor freedom again.

Rebuilding trust in the organization

The current situation was caused by systematic failures. Space Wizards Federation and Robust Interactive LLC would go through an audit in terms of how bylaws and director responsibilities can be adapted to avoid this and similar situations happening in the future, performed by the restoration team. This includes substantiated commitments to transparency and oversight, and changes to the organization

structure. I do not have the exact details on what these would be at this time (though I am sure we all have our thoughts), as it would require a proper post-mortem on this incident to identify failures that we can commit to fixing. I am also aware that there are legal challenges here in terms of organization ownership and how to affect transfers. The current BoD has my full commitment to ensuring that these are handled properly, and it has my trust that it would affect the necessary changes to achieve the transfer. Due to the current turbulence of staff personnel involvement I can not give a name for who would be the person(s) enacting the legal requirements in the US, but should the BoD accept the transfer as described in this proposal, steps would be taken to resolve this.

Thank you all for taking the time to read this proposal. Amendments have been included below.

Amendment 1:

This amendment sets that the current remaining active director, Veritable, remains in their current official position as a director but makes a stated declaration that the rebuilding process is to be led by the rebuilding team, with themselves stepping back into an advisory role. This is motivated by:

- The legal and structural limitations set in place which would make a full and immediate removal untenable for the organization, necessitating them remaining in their position.
- The stated commitment by Veritable to ensure a proper restoration process for Wizden. Veritable would be able to action this with the current org through emergency measures as the sole active director. Veritable, as a director, would as consequence also have dismissal power if the work does not progress according to the mission, unless delegated.

Amendment 2:

This proposal is functional with and approves of the concept of an oversight committee. This committee would be monitoring the restoration team to ensure that their job is followed, but importantly should not govern the restoration team. The committee should consist of people with vested interest in Wizden's restoration, and from different parts of the community. It is proposed but not required that Veritable delegates his ability to revoke the emergency measures enabling the restoration group to the oversight committee.

Amendment 3:

The individuals proposed for the restoration team would need to be first presented to involved staff and ex-staff aiming to return, and be approved by general consensus.

PROPOSAL ENDS

geeky: per veritable: wants 2-way communications between downstreams not siloed (geeky agrees), auth separated from wizden (geeky agrees), however statements made today that worry geeky about working back or retractions from statement.

going section by section, 4 parts: rebuilding trust in staff leadership-1. current BoD not tenable solution. interim directors are not satisfactory for staff (not mark against them, just situation). desired transfer to a group of individuals with high standing in staff and community. people chosen based on ability to bring back people who do have ability and expertise to lead. judgement to create the right path for wizden.

2- infra. infra needs to be isolated from wizden to provide a safety net- even if wizden peters out in 5 years infra should continue. split off to seperate team/entity, still under robust LLC. overlap between engine and content. personnel split off. infra personnel sentiment: not happy with BoD structure, focused on survival of infrastructure. geeky to check in with them.

3- rebuilding trust in upstream. permanent losses to personnel on the project, a lot of people hurt, nobody happy. not feasible for the development team to continue in the same vein. downstreams need reassurance about the reliability of the upstream development platform. drastic reduction on scope of upstream content proposed, shift to focus on documentation and bugfixes. after stable will move to focused developments. will have drawbacks- less contributions, less new features, slow development. will impact the game branch. will also become a more reliable and higher quality project. hivehum to speak on this a bit later. treat wizden like any other downstream? too early to make this call, a possibility.

4- rebuilding trust in org. BoD did not work. audit for bylaws, etc of wizden & robust LLC, performed by previously mentioned individuals (restoration team). not sure of exact details, general idea that an audit should happen for a proper postmortem. no legal challenges, geeky sole member of LLC. not sure why veri says he has some legal obligation. no bylaws in charter, geeky hasnt signed anything. went to a lawyer, found no issue. will handle properly if veritable says he needs something.

amendment 1 says veritable remains in position as director but steps back into an advisory role. motivated by structural limitations. concession made by geeky with veritable.. geeky does not think legal thing is a problem. restoration team to propose things, veritable to have dismissal power if work does not go according to mission. goes hand in hand with:

amendment 2: an oversight committee that would not govern the restoration team (eg, SCC). proposed that veri delegates dismissal power to the oversight committee.

amendment 3- restoration team to be approved by wizden staff/ex staff as general vote

slam: Anything involving bank account holdings to your knowledge?

geeky: geeky sole owner, under geeky federal tax number, veri not involved

hive: so to clarify. what legal requirements are forcing veritable to remain as a director?

geeky: none

ret: I'm a bit concerned that this is the first time I heard about the 1 on 1 discussion Veritable apparently participated in. Kind of a rugpull.

geeky: apologies, happened last night, asked for slams proposal to move forward as viewed position untenable

aexxie: I only learned about this discussion earlier today, long after it happened and decisions were made.

ret: lot of time putting out fires, all good

snappingopossum: I think there needs to be something limiting the actions Veritable can take alone to prevent a centralisation of power. This only really applies if the thing about Veritable staying as director stays

geeky: agreed, would like to edit amendment 1

trosling: I suppose, from our perspective, we are sort of wondering what this actually solves. Doesn't this just shuffle the risk to this new infra team?

geeky: same infra team as last time. also looking for downstream people to contribute to the engine. actual infrastructure (keys, etc) will probably stay- cant just give out keys to auth. but will welcome new people.

slam: thank you for listening, proposal lot of hard work, glad a lot of people have same thoughts

Taydeo's proposal

tay: slideshow to share. thanking geeky, slam, rest of wizden for being here. earlier some confusion in chat, but all present care about game.

slides co-written by folks in macrocosm, pdf to be provided. will share after the meeting.

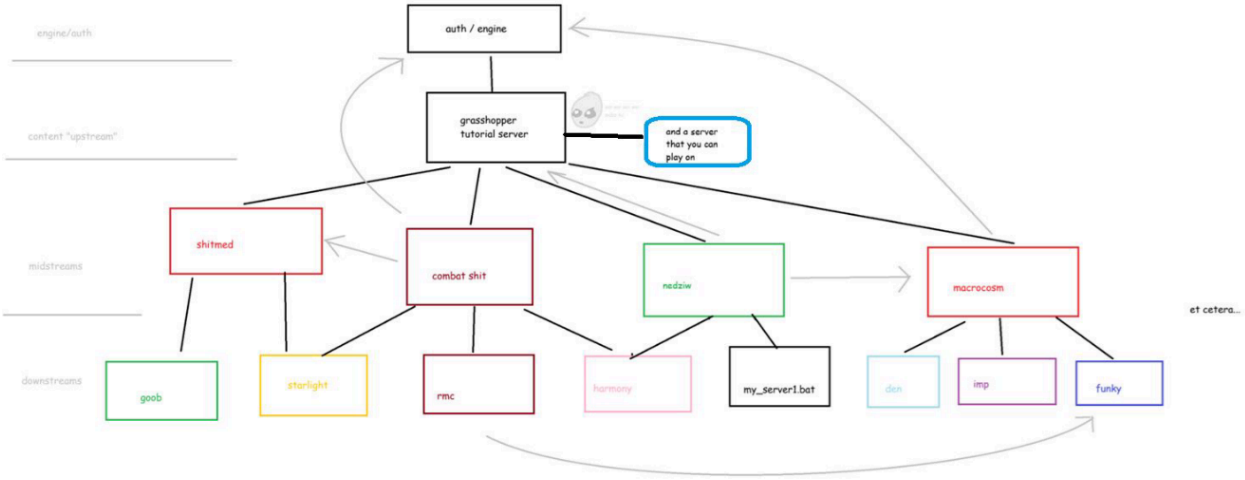
hivehum: we worked on this collectively but because of macrocosm policy we cant say that it was made by macrocosm but staff from all microcosms were involved in its creation

TAYDEO'S SLIDESHOW TRANSCRIPT:

Let's diagnose the issues

From my perspective, Wizden...

1. Wizden had no clear direction in terms of what the server was supposed to be + content for it.
2. Specific people within the organization grandstanded but never did anything of substance.
3. An organization who controls critical services whilst also being opinionated over the game design and direction of their own server spells disaster.
4. The SCC did not do enough to force Wizden to have a direction last time they were heavily involved.



Ok what the fuck is that diagram

The base - Used to refer to Auth, Steam, Launcher, Engine, etc.

The base is everything, regardless of downstream or whatever, is what everyone needs. This will be controlled by the current Wizden DevOps team. Also includes the Patreon, along with the steam page.

How should the Base organize themselves?

While this needs to be discussed, they should be able to select how they govern themselves. I personally believe that leaving them intact is fine, with them drafting new rules of governance so everyone is on the same page. This matters especially for the Hub, as we all know how things got when the Hub was seen as an opinionated, biased place. While of course, nothing in the world is unbiased, having clear rules is the first step in ensuring accountability.

Also, as a long term mission, making these services easy to spin up and replicate as a commitment to making the game even more resilient. Long term project of course.

Grasshopper

Grasshopper - A target for the engine to build for.

A server that is designed to be the first thing people look to when creating a new SS14 fork, as well as a place for new players to join and introduce themselves to SS14. Specifically LRP.

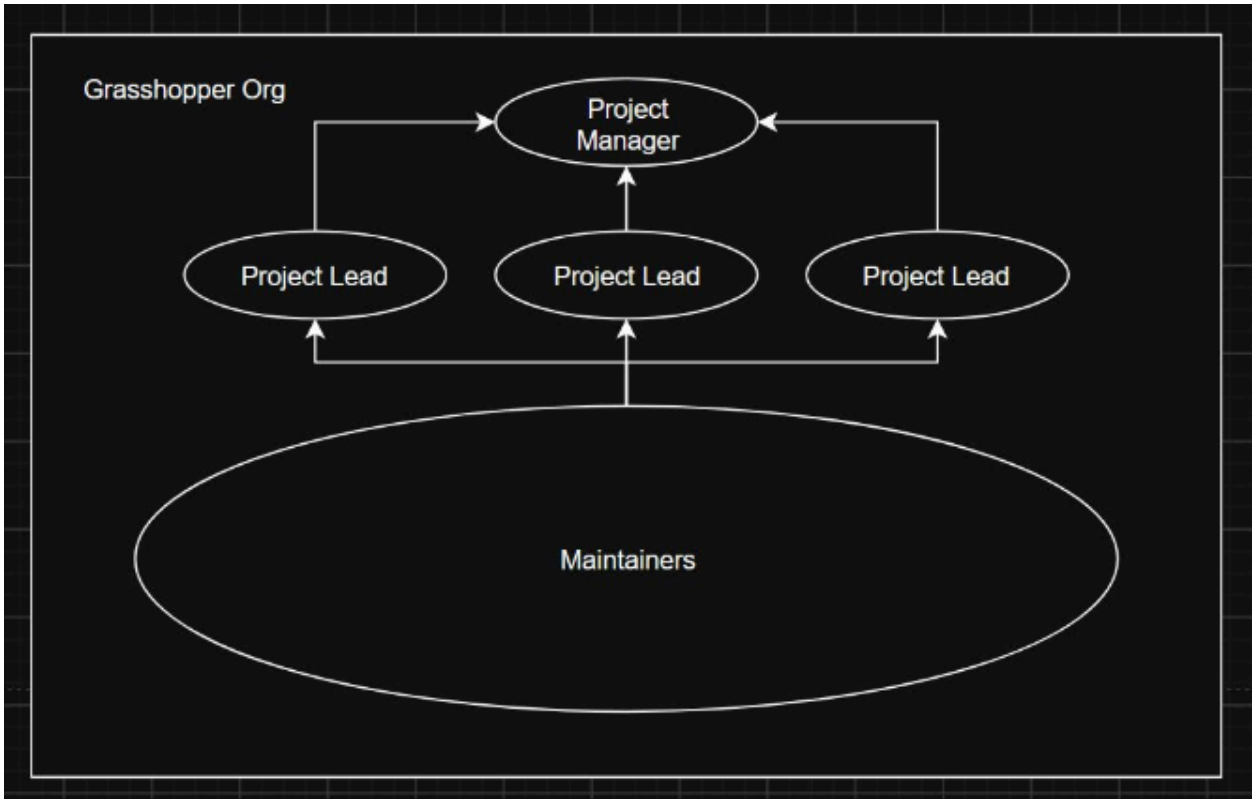
Why Grasshopper?

Grasshopper is the project that RobustToolbox is built for. For now anyway. Engine still needs content to build against, and having a clear explicit design goal instead of the vague “It was in 13!!!!” will help.

This does not mean no new content. Every 6 months or so, there will be a review of the Game Design Document that determines what Grasshopper is, and this is the opportunity for downstream developers to propose their ideas and features into the mix of Grasshopper.

(also the name grasshopper is just an easy way to show what the intent for this is, not what it should actually be called)

Isn't that design by committee?
No. Grasshopper has the explicit goal of creating a welcoming new player experience for core Space Station gameplay. To support this, an initial meeting for Grasshopper maints (which in my eyes will mainly be made up of former Wizden who agree with this premise) should create a draft for a Game Design Document. Before that though, positions will look like this.



Why still Project Leads and Managers?
Firstly, a single manager. Secondly, this is where the fight over an opinionated upstream will start. Quite frankly, we all understand that game design is opinionated. And we still need people at the helm to resolve conflicts in terms of security and opinions differing in game design.

And most important of all, this is just a theory on how to best run an organization like this. If this doesn't work, downstreams can easily spin up their own Grasshopper-like servers (servers specifically oriented towards a new player experience), and eventually working with the Base to become a new build target. (Also, there CAN be more than one build target!)

About the Process
Earlier I said every 6 months there's a review of the GDD. Why? And what even is the GDD?

- The GDD is THE document for how this Grasshopper server is designed. Everything about this Grasshopper server should be elaborated on here. Not to the point of individual items or whatever, but systems and overviews of features should be given here.
- The GDD is necessary since this is the way downstreams and players of this Grasshopper server can know what is coming and what is changing.

So... why every 6 months?

Every 6 months is just an arbitrary number. But, the idea of a comprehensive review that takes place so maintainers on Grasshopper can review their work and goals is more than helpful, as it lays the foundation for a development process that is more methodical and easier to follow. Sure, the old "move fast break shit" ethos can work, but for a proper upstream project like this one, it just has to move slower.

Not only that, but establishing Grasshopper with an explicit goal in-mind will help move things along smoothly. Hell, if things are completed, the review can happen early, with a notification in the bridge or something.

Midstreams / Downstreams

The truth is, downstreams still need an upstream. Security fixes, system refactors, and other important things like support for Content and sprites will come from Grasshopper, or whatever potential replacement it might be.

So how do downstreams fold into everything? (I)

Downstreams are the life and blood of this game. Downstreams have shown that in times of crisis, they can step up to replace whatever. Downstreams also have quite a bit of talent in them, and Wizden as a body has shown that it can flop handling talent in so many ways. The stories and screenshots of contributors and maintainers alike sharing how project managers can be rude and disrespectful, while also not caring about downstreams can easily turn off so much talent from the game. So how do we prevent this?

So how do downstreams fold into everything? (II)

Downstreams can propose engine PRs on their own, and a lot of the intimidation that comes to creating something for the engine is gone. Since Wizden project maints also had responsibility maintaining or managing PRs for content, this air of exclusivity was cultivated. This exclusivity resulted in people thinking they were not good enough to develop for the engine. This is antithetical to the open-source nature of Space Station, and the very act of decoupling engine and content alone will do wonders for the enthusiasm of contributors. Not only that, but by changing the culture of engine PRs from something that take ages to look at, since again, these maintainers also had responsibilities outside of SS14 and responsibilities for content, to something that can be reviewed by a larger base of contributors for downstreams and engine, we can get even more people involved.

So how do downstreams fold into everything? (III)

I do want to point out, downstreams could do this anyway. But personally, I've felt turned away from proposing anything since I've seen the screenshots and messages sent by higher ups at Wizden talking about PRs or specific contributors. This decoupling however has made me look at things differently.

Also, a significant source of innovation has come from experiences that do NOT follow the formula of Space Station. Persistence Station, CrystalEdge, TTT all have the potential to become spheres of influence and operate in the same manner as Grasshopper does for their specific genre, offering a clear path for contributors to get engine and content PRs upstreamed (like Z-Levels as an example) so these features can be spread out accordingly.

These upstreams also carry the power of standardization. For example, if a surgery system was downstream, and in the next review meeting a downstream asked for their surgery system to be evaluated, by putting it on the docket, and if it makes it onto the GDD, it now becomes something downstreams can plan or accommodate for, if they so choose.

What if Grasshopper doesn't follow through with plans? (I)

If Grasshopper decides to ignore its GDD or just not do meetings, downstreams can simply no longer endorse Grasshopper as a good place for new players / an upstream, and create their own.

Grasshopper should by no means be an "OFFICIAL" experience, but one that most downstreams should endorse in the beginning. Most Space Station-like experiences on the Hub rely on existing Content systems, so having a server that can run the (required for engine) base content repository is desirable for standardization and bug fixes.

If this fails, it would suck, but it wouldn't be an existential threat to the game. In such an instance, a group of servers could decide to maintain a new collective upstream.

What if Grasshopper doesn't follow through with plans? (II)

The former Wizden PR team is interested in bringing back the bridge as part of Base. In addition to its previous duties this would be the space to raise concerns if Base and/or Grasshopper deviate from their purpose.

Grasshopper would be considered a downstream with a rep/dignitary.

Wizden (if it continues to exist) would be considered a downstream with a rep/dignitary.

If communication fully breaks down then the SCC or a group like it should reform and decide on a new upstream/Base structure. We've done it once and we'll do it again.

The Launcher

The Launcher needs to be redone. This redesign should be headed by the Base, and involve input from members of the SCC to make sure it can meet the goals of what was outlined here. (No official servers, new player experiences are advertised higher, just as a start to get conversation going.)

I figure this can be sorted out by the SCC.

So what about Wizden?

Trust in Wizden has been shattered throughout the community.

- Wizden has carried this reputation for being tough to work with and immovable.
- Wizdens current leadership is not trustworthy (leadership as of today, Oct 10th, 2026).
- Using the Wizden Org invites the idea of people who have left the organization can rejoin based on seniority or previous experience. This is part of what landed us in hot water this time. There are more points, but the best option for the future SS14 as a whole is to leave Wizden behind and go all in on a new organization that can better serve the community.

SLIDESHOW ENDS

tay: previous 6 months org failed- analysis on how. also identified by slam. wizden did not meet a set of concrete plans, was left up in air to former wizden content maints. frustrating.

diagram shared of proposal.

base- auth, launcher, steam, etc. to be managed by former devops team. awesome people. organisation to be discussed, advocating for self governance. They have done a great job so far with ample time for notices and everything. shout out. Long term mission making services easier to spin up will help game resilience long term.

grasshopper target for engine to build for. content which downstreams fork off, and server for new players to learn ss14. Why is it needed? is the project robust toolbox is made for. engine absolutely needs build target. currently vague 'it was in 13 so we should add it'. proposed review biannual of new design docs. NOT design by committee. A team of former wizden maints who want to work on project again, need a design doc. organization can change to fit whatever needed. game design opinionated, still need people at the helm to resolve conflicts. security fixes (eg resharper) require a central system- example of why a central upstream was needed. also example: bug of command injection. importantly, if grasshopper doesn't work, downstreams can make their own build target.

6 months- review of game design doc (GDD). everything should be in that doc. necessary so downstreams and players know what is coming/changing. 6 months arbitrary number, but desired for comprehensive review on development- "move fast break shit" works for downstreams, upstream need to move slower. bridge mentioned.

midstreams/downstreams- still need an upstream for support & bugfixes. how do they fold into everything: life and blood of this game. downstreams shown that they can step up and have a lot of talent. downstreams can propose engine prs on their own- intimidation of creating something for the engine gone. prior air of exclusivity. resulted in people thinking they were not good enough for engine dev. Decoupling of engine/content, changing culture of engine for larger base of people, helps this. wizden storied history of downstreams being reluctant to pr engine- not indictment. Mention of wider servers that have potential to become spheres of influence for specific genres (z levels), downstream development.

standardization- eg surgery system downstream sent upstream on GDD, downstreams can now accommodate this in future.

if grasshopper fails downstreams have the power to make their own. Having a server to run a base content repo is desirable- if it fails it will suck, but not existential threat.

The former wizden PR team wants to revive the bridge. grasshopper to be considered equal to downstreams within the bridge. plans proposed for possible breakdown of structure. launcher mentioned- intricacies to be worked out.

What about wizden? trust shattered. reputation for hard to work with & immovable. not a dig at anyone. influence that veri or other figures have put people off to proposals involving him because of shattered trust. Veritable regards SCC as a "clique-y" community per meeting video. This is part of why communications broke down. The best option is to leave wizden behind and go all in on a new org.

Thanks to ret for being here. did not expect anyone from wizden to be here in an official capacity but is deeply appreciated.

princess: The proposals should be kissing sloppy style I think

trosling: issues discussed are issues with systemic structure. The proposal has a lot of structural changes. How will deciding contents of GDD avoid the same fail state?

tay: a lot of talent in downstreams, cyclical process. specifics of how people chosen should be a separate meeting, would like to see wizden part of that. to make sure this doesn't happen, GDD will BE the plan. unsure how to phrase. issue prior to PJB situation- sweeping changes made with no downstream notice. by making process slower, downstreams have more of a chance to speak about it, and features have time to be implemented thoughtfully. refactors should all be proposed and planned for. plans are vague atm, but the process of reviewing GDD should be what stops the same situation.

upandleaves: text of proposal: idea that grasshopper would not be official required upstream. The engine does require a build target, but if grasshopper independent from infra then they can make their own decisions. will ALWAYS need to be relying on an infra team. hopefully more people coming in from downstreams, but will have to assume there is always someone. from experience working with others in devops, they have never been an issue.

mq: proposal will also give us room to establish avenues to hold devops accountable if need arises

tay: threat of downstreams being able to up and leave is the accountability (upandleaves???). The idea of maintaining a separate engine fork is kind of scary. A lot of talent exists here, we all care about the game.

FSP: not critical- slide of project base structure good example of struggle with proposals. The challenge becomes that if we start from a proposal, if it doesn't work in 6 months, we need to be able to provide avenues to challenge the objective success of the proposal. Last time had a situation where a proposal happened and was never really audited, org exploded on the first director meeting. proposal needs to have plans / criteria that measure if it is working, and how to act if it doesn't work.

tay: proposal already provides a framework for this, can codify in future meeting to ensure those avenues exist. should first handle org and infrastructure, all else small potatoes. proposal to chat

june: Do people agree (infra is the thing that needs to be independent if proposal goes through)? (24 YES, 0 NO, 0 ABSTAIN)

PDF of slides sent to chat.

Jimboe's proposal

jimboe: apologies for being scattered, haven't had much time to piece thoughts together. will write a written proposal after the meeting.

big issue wizden: people at top cannot be immune to the same expectations people at bottom have. not attack on anyone, but need to ensure policy where leadership not held to different standard of eg. regular admin. respect as a 2-way street. proposal that regardless of whatever moves forward, non-negotiably need a regulatory body for leadership that cannot be overstepped by project leadership. entity or collective should be a separate department.

next proposal: if we don't see any movement from wizden in an arbitrary timeframe, SCC should move forward regardless. After the PJB situation a timeframe was given and things looked very hopeful, SCC moved separate ways. The sky shouldn't be falling as much. Things need to get better quickly because downstreams have the capacity to fix it themselves if wizden doesn't. People love this game and if things don't improve people will bleed out of the project.

generally: disciplinary actions should be strict, and come from a separate org, and we need to give wizden a timeline. cannot keep putting own forks at risk due to upstream collateral damage.

nairod: 3rd time heard of a HR / Staff manager position; first time during end times of PJB (was immediately overshadowed), staff managers existed post reorg, unsure of circumstances. How is this enforced?

jimboe: has to be in the charter. DeltaV runs similarly- head mod can remove any head of staff if there's a major policy violation. need to have a body of people that ensures decisions made are for the good of the project and not just short-term bandaids. replacing the head of the project may be necessary for the project's long term health. cannot give someone running the project the ability to discipline themselves.

nairod: agree as long as they have actual authority.

leaves: re tays proposal: base as auth team, grasshopper as just additional thing which tays proposal contains but slams does not.

hive: the accountability process available to us is to take our bag and leave. We don't have any way to force people to get removed from positions of authority. This is the tool that we have. Any accountability process is ultimately a trust position. Downstream unionization is the number 1 negotiation tool.

trosling: agree as the only hard option. would like to explore alternatives to nuclear option, potential legal avenues to ensure accountability. want to avoid high tensions especially in interpersonal disputes.

august: I will also say that part of what I was working on behind the scenes at WizDen was organizing a legal mechanism of accountability. third proposal most practical

princess: I would like to back up Trosling here. An issue we had with Director accountability is that the only options were: Staff Complaint and pray it gets enforced. Ideally you don't want to rely on all complaints going through one avenue, you need a wide gradient.

tay: idea that people will immediately hard fork- where are they going to hard fork from? only so many things to disagree about when it comes to engine. The problem is more in content. example of shitmed on goob- people have already hard forked over content, but use the same engine. The point of separating auth & engine/content is to avoid this. people already hard fork wizden all the time on content side, eg. ephemeral space, other themed experiences (trouble in space station, shipforks, mining station). disagree that hard forking is always going to be effective as a negotiation tool.

jimboe: also ask wizden to allow anyone who left the project within the last 2 weeks to be reinstated if they request. should not just throw these people in willy nilly, should reinstate them thoughtfully.

Speaking time for anyone who wants it (RAISE YOUR HAND!!!!!!!!)

Aquif

AQUIF SHARES WRITTEN THOUGHTS:

Since I am probably going to be late and or not make the meeting today I wanted to write out my thoughts. Feel free to link to and or copy this gist in the meeting notes.

Wizden

I am not personally going to accept wizden having any control over shared infrastructure at this point. I think that ship has sailed. Wizden has had more than enough chances to get their affairs in order and has proven to be unable to do that.

What I would want from wizden:

- Transfer of the auth database and steam page into an organization formed by the broader community
- A public statement stating that space-wizards/* repos are not the canonical source for the game.

Beyond that I don't really care what wizden does and to be honest the above are just an ask. I intend to work on creating a third party org at this point as long as there is interest irrespective of what wizden does.
Structure of a new organization

I think a new organization should have the following qualities:

- Should not be dependant on one person to do something
- Should allow people to take breaks as much as needed without blocking anything organizationally
- Should be somewhat non-hierarchical to support points 1 and 2 and to stop bad actors from destroying the project.
- Should have some sort of COC committe
- Should be very transparent and not have private discussion for anything other than stuff which absolutely cannot be public (eg. moderation)

My proposal for a new organization is to have smaller atomic units called special interest groups (SIGs) which in turn report to a governing council which is elected by project members on some fixed term.

SIGs would have ownership over a section of the project (eg. all or part of a codebase, community management, release engineering, system administration) and project members could join and leave SIGs at their option. The governing council would only exist to settle disputes between SIGs and to allocate their responsibilities. SIGs should be able to set their own polices based on some fixed standardized template. Community members should have a way of formally joining SIGs but would not have a vote until becoming project members.

There should also be a fixed committee analogous to a COC committee that is responsible for enforcing member policy and moderators should be fully separate from developers.

Feel free to poke holes in the above and I am happy to respond to critiques if/when I am present. I have thought a lot about this over the past few weeks.

STATEMENT ENDS

aquif: proposal fairly similar to tays. 3-5 walkouts in past few years. organisation basically a walking corpse. proposal that auth, steam page, etc (assuming wizden willing, if not can just do it ourselves) org should be non-hierarchical. helps people who want to take breaks not be blockers. also reduces risk of corruption.

also believe the engine should be split, mention of libraries being run inside robust toolbox project for how to handle content.

FSP

fsp: conversations in chat: cant rely on wizden, how do we handle core system, lots of decision making. proposing notion of no singular organisation to make top-down decisions. SCC is a downstream organization, doesn't make the same decisions re. production. need more feeder orgs into an overall decision body.

e.V as legal owners of organization, composed of multiple feeder orgs. fed in as a group of people elected from SCC, an arbitrary board to make decisions. SCC and wizden as equal stakeholders. holding each other accountable. not just 'wizden is the upstream', downstream orgs as having a stake legally in the project.

speaking to own experience, hearing that only one person has legal control over the entire project, no e.V set up. no pressure to properly establish legal safeguards that were determined to be needed after the PJB situation.

aquif: response to FSP- wizden needs to not be involved in upstream. personal opinion. no offense, but loss of trust. tangentially extends to devops team. would like to completely ignore wizden. dont want to take the space wizards name, dont think transferring github org accomplishes anything productive beyond a power play. would like to fully know who is on devops team, didnt know julian and simyon were on it

princess: members are Simyon, Julian, Myra, Nyx, Ress, Scholar, Fildrance

August

august: following up on e.V vs LLC discussions. legal concerns around the content of the game relating to german law. august looking into other legal structures that acted similarly. 2 ones that were looked at were Blender and Godot - both as stichting. did some outreach to the blender foundation, emailed and called the president of blender foundation. sharing notes of that meeting.

AUGUST SHARES NOTES OF MEETING WITH BLENDER PRESIDENT:

- Blender is organized in a way that makes sure that the Blender Foundation is legally liable to its own statutes, as well as making sure that Blender itself as an IP
- Blender organizes its hierarchy based on modules (analogous to our areas of responsibility) but these areas aren't designated by statute
- Blender is 4 board members, governed by a higher supervisory board (including the founder); the board members are governed by the supervisory board, and administrates the program
- Blender's structure is fundamentally reliant on dedicated contributors, developers and funders, and the validation of that is vital
- Funding/incorporating internationally isn't a huge issue, unless we start seeing a huge amount of revenue/capital pass through what we're building

NOTES END

stichting organisation legally held by founding articles, any revenue legally obligated to go back into the organization. was in the process of reaching out to dutch civil notary in coordination with ress, was told by veritable to look elsewhere/consider other opportunities when checking in. agree that there will need some legal protections.

princess: August and Ress and Geeky did most of the business side when it was active

UpAndLeaves

UpAndLeaves provides opinionated summary of proposals:

UpAndLeaves' opinionated summary of the various proposals. It presumes you've heard the proposals themselves.

These proposals are textually different, as described below.

- Both Slam and Tay propose a form of ISI (Independent SS14 Infra)
- Only Slam proposes direct changes to WizDen's BoD
- Only Tay proposes a cross-community changeable upstream, separate from Tay's proposed ISI.
- Both Slam and Jimboe propose changes to accountability.

ISI form

Slam proposes that ISI be a sub-org under RI LLC.

Tay proposes a completely independent ISI (called Base in their proposal).

Jimboe expresses support for an ISI but does not go into detail.

BoD

Slam proposes an array of replacements to WizDen's organisation.

Upstream

Tay proposes a cross-community upstream (called Grasshopper in their proposal), acknowledging that it would not be "official" like WizDen currently is.

Accountability

Both Slam and Jimboe request accountability boards.

Slam requests one for WizDen.

Jimboe proposes one for ISI as a whole.

summary ends

Hivehum

hivehum: proposing a formal vote: hard deadline for wizden to give github to devops, if they do not, we hard fork and clone all git resources. very simple and very actionable vote. non important resource as a measure of trust. well defined goalpost.

slam: What does "relinquish to the devops team" actually mean? What entity is the devops team?

hivehum: all wizden staff not part of devops team removed from github org.

nairod: For reference, the current owners of the github org are: Electro, the tech director, Emisse, Julian, Simyon, *Valquaint/Rei. Everyone except Julian and Simyon removed.

ret/aexxie: wizden reps agreeing to abstain. it is clarified that vote is not occurring right now

r3d: asking for "destructive action" as an ultimatum before we've even really come to a consensus on what we're looking for in structure (after hearing these proposals) just doesn't make sense to me

hivehum: slam's proposal written with cooperation from wizden- preliminary agreement that auth and engine should be split. requesting a deadline to follow through. non destructive proposal, just transfer of assets.

june: We should come back to this point later. people in the queue to speak.

mqole

mqole: There was conflict between Geeky and Veritable's account on the legal situation of the project. Who owns what? Who are the bodies that have legal stake? Who controls the assets (Auth, GitHub, Server, etc.)

geeky: during PJB formed robust interactive: owns steam, the tax stuff, the bank account, the cloudflare, the hosting provider... all infra held by LLC, which geeky is sole member of- asked multiple times over last 5 months for veri etc to provide formation docs to codify directors and update legal charter, never provided.

legal state: if you sued the LLC you would just be suing geeky, thats how the single member LLC works. There are no bylaws. There are just general boilerplate formation docs.

Why are there no bylaws? These were requested many times, never provided. nothing codified legally. directors never got it to geeky.

spoke to veritable about it last night. Veri signed an NDA with Xbox for ss14 (nothing came of it), that's about it, but from legal & technical standpoint veritable is uninvolved with LLC.

nyx: What about the stuff union™ talked about with regards to a stichting/eV/whatever? Is there anything we want to bring up in that regard

geeky: founding LLC was the easiest/simplest thing at the time, moving to a different foundation is the optimal path forward.

taydeo

taydeo: what now? proposal for an immediate vote. Geeky has shown a lot of tenacity and faithfulness towards the project, lots of trust. would like to at minimum endorse that auth and infra being seperate from game content. not sure of wording. general sentiment to be agreed upon.

mqole: isnt this just the ongoing SCC vote

nairod: The ongoing vote is to hardfork. Which is different from working with WizDen.

fsp: will draft up a wording of a vote

Trosling

trosling: follow up questions to legal: have read minutes but couldn't attend last meeting fully. understanding that legal layer proposed, but never actually implemented. Did things break down? What happened?

geeky: accountability for directors were staff managers to handle complaints. got silo'd into staff managers only giving recommendations. became that only directors could handle other directors. did believe that there was a want for inter-directional accountability. directors holding each other accountable does not work, that's why all fell apart.

june: meeting approaching the 2 hour mark. moving into final questions. 3 options not mutually exclusive, situation hopefully conveyed to all. 5 minute break.

vote proposal per FSP:

We believe that:

1. Due to repeated issues with Space Wizards Federation ("Wizden"), the current structure of upstream is not sustainable and needs to change.
2. Wizden's roles as management of project infrastructure and core dependencies, and upstream content creation for Space Station 14, are separate roles better suited to two separate organizations.

We therefore call for:

1. A new organization to be formed that contains responsibility for maintenance and development of the following aspects of the project:

a) Auth, DevOps, and related Space Station 14 backend ("infra").

b) The Space Station 14 launcher

c) Robust Toolbox

d) Steam store integration

e) Other aspects of the project that are deemed essential to fulfilling the above responsibilities.

2. The current Wizden organization's role to be reduced in scope sufficiently so as not to clash with this new organization, or, if needed, is disbanded and replaced with a new organization that is strictly scoped to the development of a vanilla Space Station 14 codebase suitable for use by both new players and new downstreams.

proposal ends

taydeo: should this be a representative only vote: (9 YEA, 0 NAY, 6 ABSTAIN)

aquif: I would also like to propose a vote for here (anyone can vote): Should the SCC form a discourse or other forum instance which will eventually become the forum for the above project if it is made to allow for better project organization (4 YEA, 6 NAY, 6 ABSTAIN)

mqole: like the idea because discord sucks for long term discussion. would personally like to wait on actioning it because so much is going on.

aexxie: agree with mq, would like it to be operated by same team as infrastructure

aquif: discourse makes it very easy to import/export data, can easily make something temporary if needed

aexxie: have addressed the main concern of transferring to a new org.

nyx: DevOps is already managing PII and under rules with that regard so if it was something like discourse, which stores ips and emails, we're already equipped to deal with the legal side of that

aexxie: pending discussion (not all directors present), wizden willing to cooperate with SCC. want to see the project thrive, and agree that some things do need to change. would like to set up a way to communicate with SCC more easily. want to integrate SCC into a wizden communication channel for the time being and possibly bring back bridge, maybe with some of the SCC folks. pending further discussion about revamped bridge.

mqole: apologies for being annoying with pings in wiz general chat. SCC is a collective, and doesn't really have any singular reps beyond discord moderation. would it be ok to have a channel/thread in the SCC discord for wizden to communicate?

aexxie: want to make sure that whatever is made is an option for whoever comes next. a channel in SCC or something is a great starting point to repair damage done.

june: vote (14 YEA, 0 NAY, 0 ABSTAIN)

aquif: I will just do it

trosling: any status on the legal side of things @geeky?

geeky: on pause until everyone figures out what they want to do. kind of like last time. as long as everyone gets a say will be good.

trosling: more in the sense of investigating possibilities of organizations available. What options exist?

geeky: a lot. non-profit 501c in USA a pain due to tax filing reqs. sitchting, e.V, CIC all mentioned to look into. pros and cons- part of why no consensus was reached is that everyone was looking for a perfect solution, which doesn't exist.

trosling: starlight still interested in this avenue as it wasn't really given a fair shot before things exploded.

august: one of the discoveries for sichting: have to go through dutch civil notary, not difficult (especially bc global organization), just an involved process. biggest concerns: 1. are there limitations for having international members, not a huge worry per Blender, 2. If money goes to/through org, what's the limit threshold before org is held to higher scrutiny, per Blender is not an issue unless a certain amount of revenue is generated far beyond what SS14 is doing. Dutch perspective: not as much of a hurdle as initially anticipated.

mqole: usual fare re. meeting minutes, wizden free to share internally for 24 hour clarification/redaction period. much thanks to all wizden attendees especially ret and aexxie for stepping up in communications and attendance.